

Mauritius Examinations Syndicate

PSAC 2025

Kreol Morisien

Examiners' Report

Subject code: P220

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Key messages

- Candidates performed best in direct-response tasks such as matching, multiple-choice grammar and contextual vocabulary (Questions 1, 2 and 3B).
- Exact written production remained much weaker than recognition. This was especially visible in Question 3A, in syntax and rewriting tasks, and most clearly in Questions 8A, 8B and 9.
- Open-ended reading items requiring explanation or inference were more demanding than closed items, particularly in Question 4B.
- Sentence writing remained fragile when candidates had to use all the given words in one coherent sentence. In Question 8A, only 33.5% of the sampled scripts obtained full marks for the third picture.
- Composition remained the weakest component overall. The mean score for Question 9 was 4.01/10 and 29% of the sampled scripts scored zero.

General comments

This report is based on the PSAC 2025 Kreol Morisien question paper, the mark scheme, and the statistical item analysis from a representative sample of scripts. The observations below should therefore be read as evidence-based pedagogical findings drawn from the sampled scripts, and not as a statement about every individual script in the full cohort.

The overall mean on the sampled scripts was 63.86/100, with a median of 76. Half of the sample fell in the 75–100 range. The strongest sections were Questions 1, 2 and 3B. The weakest sections were Question 3A, the productive parts of Questions 5, 8A and 8B, and, above all, the composition in Question 9.

Question	Maximum mark	Mean mark
Q1	5	4.17
Q2	10	8.11
Q3A	5	2.15
Q3B	5	4.22
Q4A	10	7.16
Q4B	15	10.40
Q5	10	6.11

Question	Maximum mark	Mean mark
Q6A	5	3.56
Q6B	5	2.74
Q7A	5	2.80
Q7B	5	2.98
Q8A	6	3.27
Q8B	4	2.21
Q9	10	4.01
Total	100	63.86

Question 1

Question 1 assessed basic reading comprehension through a matching task. Performance was strong across all five items, with facility values ranging from 81.5% to 85.5%. Most candidates were able to link each sentence in Column A to the appropriate continuation in Column B.

The results suggest that candidates cope well when the task depends on direct meaning and when the response format is highly structured. This remains an encouraging sign for basic reading comprehension.

Pedagogical implication: Educators should continue working on short cause-and-effect reading activities, but should gradually move learners from recognition to short written justification so that this basic strength transfers into more open-ended response tasks.

Question 2

Question 2 tested grammar through ten multiple-choice items covering prepositions, tense marking, conjunctions, interrogative forms and pronouns. Overall performance was good, with a mean of 8.11/10. Most items were answered correctly by more than three-quarters in the sample.

The more demanding items were Item 8 (77.5%) and Item 9 (71.0%). These items required precise control of prepositions and interrogative selection in context. The distractors suggest that some learners still confuse location, time, quantity and person questions, or rely on a loose sense of meaning rather than exact grammatical fit.

For Item 8, both ‘akote’ and ‘lor’ were accepted.

Pedagogical implication: grammar teaching should remain strongly contextualised. Learners need repeated practice choosing the correct form in a meaningful sentence and explaining why distractors provided are unsuitable.

Question 3A

Question 3A was the weakest of the more objective-type questions. It tested vocabulary retrieval together with accurate spelling. The mean score was only 2.15/5 (43.1%).

Item (i) was found to be particularly challenging, with only 24% correct vocabulary found and written; Item (ii) had 36% correct; and Item (v) had 46.5% correct.

The contrast between Questions 3A and 3B is significant. It shows that many learners recognise vocabulary successfully when the context supports them, but struggle to retrieve and spell the exact word independently. Item (i), for example, appears to have been especially demanding because of the orthographic pattern in ‘kinkayri’.

Pedagogical implication: Educators should use thematic word banks, short dictation routines, copy-correct activities, and repeated attention to visual word patterns. The development of orthographic confidence must remain a regular classroom priority.

Question 3B

Question 3B, by contrast, was very well done. The mean score was 4.22/5 (84.4%), and all five lexical items recorded high facility values. This confirms that learners handle contextual vocabulary well when they can rely on sentence meaning to identify the right answer.

This question also suggests that candidates do not experience major difficulty selecting the correct lexical item from a list when the context is sufficiently supportive.

Pedagogical implication: Educators can use this strength as a bridge to more productive work by moving from choosing the correct word to explaining the choice, and then to using the same word in an original sentence.

Question 4A

Question 4A assessed functional reading through a poster about a missing dog. Performance was generally satisfactory, with a mean of 7.16/10. Most items fell between 70% and 76.5%, but Item 3 was weaker at 52%, and Item 4 reached 69%.

The lower result on Item 3 suggests that many candidates did not extract the required time expression precisely. Item 4 showed a common difficulty in distinguishing between cause and effect: some answers gave the result (‘Milou finn gagn per’) instead of the cause (‘Enn loto finn klaxonn for’).

Pedagogical implication: Educators should train pupils to identify exactly what type of information the question is asking for before they answer. Practice activities around ‘who?’, ‘when?’, ‘why?’ and ‘how?’ can help learners avoid over-lifting or selecting the wrong part of the text.

Question 4B

Question 4B assessed narrative reading comprehension, including direct understanding, inference, sequencing and interpretation. Overall performance was fair, with a mean of 10.40/15 (69.3%). Closed items were generally more accessible than open responses: Item 3 reached 82%, Item 4 77% and Item

5 75.5%. Item 6, which required two adjectives, produced 67% full marks and 14.5% one-mark responses.

The most demanding parts were the open items. Item 7 had 48% correct, Item 8 had 50.5%, and Item 9 had 45%. Item 10, the sequencing task, yielded 54.5% full marks. These figures show that many learners can follow the story, but have more difficulty formulating a precise explanation, identifying the central reason, or abstracting a moral from the narrative.

Pedagogical implication: Reading lessons should include more work on explanation and inference. Learners must practise moving from ‘what happened?’ to ‘why did it happen?’ and ‘what does this show?’. They should also be trained to answer open questions concisely instead of retelling the whole passage.

Question 5

Question 5 assessed syntax through ordering words, separating combined words, removing an extra word, inserting an adverb, changing a sentence into the negative, identifying capitals, changing a sentence into the interrogative, and writing a sentence from given words. The overall mean was 6.11/10 (61.1%), which makes this one of the more demanding questions on the paper.

The weaker items were revealing. Item (i), which required reordering words into a correct sentence, had 51.5% correct. Item (vi), on capitals, had only 36% correct. Item (vii), the interrogative transformation, had 47% full marks and 25.5% one-mark responses. Item (viii), which required sentence production from given words, had only 37% full marks.

The pattern across the question shows that learners often have partial control of sentence structure: they may recognise the target meaning, but lose marks through incorrect negation, incomplete interrogative patterns, weak capitalisation, or failure to use the prompt words accurately in one acceptable sentence.

Selected exemplar materials for Question 5. The short extracts below are drawn from the scripts of candidates and illustrate the difference between accurate control, partial control and weak control.

Focus	Illustrative response	What it shows
Negative form	“Li pa pe aprann sante.”	A clear and fully acceptable negative structure. The negative marker is correctly placed and the meaning remains stable.
Negative form	“Li pas pe aprann sante.”	The candidate is aiming for negation, but the structure is not secure enough for standard written Kreol Morisien.
Interrogative form	“Eski ena koko dan sa biskwila?”	A strong response: the sentence is grammatical and clearly interrogative.

Focus	Illustrative response	What it shows
Interrogative form	“Eski koko dan sa biskwi-la?”	The question marker alone is not enough; the sentence still needs a complete grammatical structure.
Sentence from given words	“Dan vakans mo kontan mont bisiklet.”	All the target words are used naturally in one acceptable sentence.
Sentence from given words	“Mo kontan monte bisiklet pandan vakans.”	The response is relevant, but the verb has not been conjugated.
Sentence from given words	“Pandan vakans mo pou lor mo bisiklet ek mo pou al zwe dan mo lakour.”	The candidate moves away from the prompt and does not control the target structure accurately enough.

Pedagogical implication: Short daily sentence work is essential. Learners should regularly transform sentences, add punctuation, correct capitals, and build one complete sentence from a small word set. Educators should insist on accuracy in sentence boundaries, because weak sentence control later undermines paragraph and composition writing.

Question 6A

Question 6A, the guided cloze task with supplied words, was handled relatively well. The mean was 3.56/5 (71.2%). This suggests that, when lexical choices are constrained and meaning is supported, many learners can complete a text appropriately.

Question 6B

Question 6B required candidates to continue the same text using their own words. As in previous years, this was more demanding, with a mean of 2.74/5 (54.8%). Items 1, 3 and 5 were especially challenging. The distribution of half marks suggests that many learners had some sense of what the text required, but their word choice or orthographic and grammatical control was not secure enough to earn full credit.

In some cases, the word chosen was syntactically correct in the sentence but did not make sense in the story. In such cases, the mark was not awarded.

The table below gives an indication of some answers that were awarded 1, ½ or 0 marks.

	1 Mark	½ Mark	0 Mark
1.	atansion	atantion, atension	• attention • prepare • trankil • zanti
2.	dir/ reponn		• deside
3.	kone/ trouve/ rode/ dekrir/ konpran/ dir/ gete	trouv/ rod	• kontign • al
4.	gran/ bel/ ti/ tipti/ long/ lasenn/ zoli/ zoli/ ta/ sime		• lot
5.	trouv/ dekouver/ ariv	trouve/ arive	• al • ena • grinp

Pedagogical implication: For tasks of this kind, learners should first read the whole text, identify the likely word class needed in each blank, and then reread the completed passage to test whether the wording sounds natural and coherent.

Question 7A

Question 7A required learners to correct faulty forms in a short text. The mean was 2.80/5 (55.9%). Item 4 was the weakest at 37.5%, while the other items ranged from 55.5% to 66%. The errors suggest continuing uncertainty about standard written forms and some interference from French-influenced spelling.

Examples such as ‘legan’, ‘sapo’, ‘soley’ and ‘aroz’ need to become visually familiar through repeated exposure. Learners do not yet seem fully confident in recognising which written form belongs in standard Kreol Morisien.

It is also worth noting that this question does not test orthography alone. One item required a grammatical correction rather than a purely orthographic one, which may have unsettled learners who are more accustomed to correcting spelling only.

Question 7B

Question 7B tested the correct verb form (short or long) in context. The mean was 2.98/5 (59.6%). Item 4 was the weakest at 42.5%, while the other items were moderate to strong. For Item 4, candidates were expected to use the short form of the verb but also to write it correctly by doubling the ‘n’ at the end of telefonn, which many did not do.

Pedagogical implication for Questions 7A and 7B: teachers should make more use of short editing passages, correction notebooks and contrast charts showing common confusions. Learners should not only correct a form but explain why the corrected form fits the sentence better.

Question 8A

Question 8A assessed sentence writing from pictures and given words. It also required candidates to maintain a coherent mini-story across three sentences. The overall mean was 3.27/6 (54.4%). Performance declined across the sequence: Picture 1 had 63.5% full marks, Picture 2 had 47%, and Picture 3 had only 33.5%. Zero marks rose from 27% on the first picture to 49% on the third.

The scripts show recurring problems: candidates did not always use all the given words, sometimes split the target words across two sentences, often showed weak syntax, or lost the narrative thread from one picture to the next.

The examples below show some selected exemplars from candidates' scripts for Question 8A.

Performance band	Illustrative sequence	Indicative mark	What it illustrates
Strong	Enn zour, yev ek torti inn deside pou al fer lekours. Apre inpe letan, yev inn desid al repoze anba enn pie, parski li kone ki torti pou pran letan. Finalman, torti ti bien kontan paski li inn gagne.	6/6	A coherent three-sentence sequence in which each prompt is converted into an acceptable sentence and the mini-story remains clear from beginning to end.
Partially successful	Enn zour yev ek torti ti pe fer enn lakours. Apre inpe letan yev desid pou repoze. Finalman torti finn ariv kot lalign ek li'nn gagne. Li ti extra kontan.	4/6 overall; last picture 0	The first two pictures are handled satisfactorily, but the third picture loses the required one-sentence control by splitting the prompt across two sentences.
Developing	Enn zour, yev ek torti deside pou fer enn lekours. Apre inpe letan yev fatigue, li al repoze li anba enn pie. Finalman torti bien kontan ki li finn gagne lekours.	4/6 overall	The narrative line is present, but sentence control is uneven and the last sentence is only partly successful.

Performance band	Illustrative sequence	Indicative mark	What it illustrates
Weak	enn zour al yen ek torit enn lekours. apre inpe letan se enn ti repaze. finalaman finn gagne kontan.”	0/6	Meaning becomes unstable because the syntax and spelling are too weak for the response to function as standard written Kreol Morisien.

Pedagogical implication: One-picture-one-sentence practice should become routine. Learners need explicit modelling on how to keep all the given words in one sentence, how to add small grammatical words correctly, and how to link three short sentences into a coherent narrative line. This question is an important bridge between sentence work and full composition writing.

Question 8B

Question 8B required learners to combine two simple sentences into one complex sentence using the connector provided. The mean was 2.21/4 (55.1%). Item 2 with ‘me’ was the easiest (72% full marks), while Item 1 with ‘depi ki’ (49%) and Item 3 with ‘kan’ (42.5%) were more difficult. Item 4 with ‘mem si’ stood at 51% full marks.

The standardisation materials show that many candidates inserted the connector but did not restructure the sentence properly, repeated words unnecessarily, or produced an awkward or incomplete construction. This suggests that connectors need to be taught not only by meaning, but also by the sentence structure they require.

In some cases it was also found that the meaning of the two sentences changed when the connector was inserted. For example, the following use of the connector for Item 3 changed the original meaning:

Kan Ryan so mama verifie so valiz, li trouve ki Ryan finn pran tro bokouzafer. (kan)

Pedagogical implication: Learners should compare pairs such as ‘me’, ‘parski’, ‘kan’, ‘mem si’ and ‘depi ki’, discuss the relationship each one expresses, and then practise combining two short sentences into one accurate sentence. It is also useful to make learners notice the difference between coordination and subordination.

Question 9

Question 9 required a composition of about 100 words on the theme of being alone at home in the evening when someone suddenly knocks at the door. This was the weakest question on the paper. The mean was 4.01/10. Twenty-nine per cent of the sampled scripts scored zero, and only 19.5% reached the 8–10 range.

The stronger scripts respected the prompt, answered the guiding bullets, built suspense, and resolved the event clearly. They showed broader sentence control and more secure temporal, spatial and causal

links. By contrast, the weaker scripts were too short, irrelevant, left unfinished, or burdened by so many errors in syntax, spelling and punctuation that meaning became unstable.

The table below provides the descriptors in the different bands used to mark the essays.

Band	Descriptors
Band 1 (9-10 marks)	• Elaborate and well developed story • G/S/P and syntax very accurate. No or very few errors • Variety of sentence structures used consistently and well • Accurate and appropriate vocabulary • Organised and coherent
Band 2 (6-8 marks)	• Quite developed story • G/S/P and syntax mostly accurate. A few errors • Beginning of complexity in sentence structures • Accurate vocabulary • Organised, but may lack fluency
Band 3 (3-5 marks)	• Basic story • G/S/P and syntax accurate enough, but errors are noticeable • Accurate but simple vocabulary • Mostly simple sentences • Organised, but not always fluent
Band 4 (1-2 marks)	• Very basic story, with very little development. • G/S/P and syntax erratic. Sense can be made, but multiple errors confuse meaning • Simple, often inaccurate vocabulary • Disjointed writing
Band 5 (0 marks)	• Meaningless • Irrelevant • Not recognisable as Kreol Rodrige

Pedagogical advice for writing development

- Move systematically from sentence writing to paragraph writing before expecting successful full compositions.
- Use a simple planning grid based on the five prompts in the question so that learners organise their ideas before they write.
- Model openings, middles and endings through shared writing before asking for independent composition.
- Develop word banks for emotions and suspense, for example: per, soulaze, ezite, krwar, dout, sagrin.
- Read and discuss short good models so that learners can see what makes a short narrative coherent and effective.

- Use correction codes close to the marking scheme, for example: C for communication or syntax, G/S/P for grammar, spelling and punctuation, and R for repeated error; then require redrafting.

Conclusion

In the 2025 sample, the main strengths in Kreol Morisien remained direct comprehension, matching, multiple-choice grammar and contextual vocabulary. The main weaknesses remained productive writing, particularly exact spelling without support, sentence construction, the use of connectors and the development of a coherent composition.

The paper clearly shows that writing weakness is not confined to a single question. It appears in sentence ordering, negative and interrogative transformation, capitalisation, sentence building from word prompts, sentence combining with connectors, and full composition. This means that writing must be taught as a progression rather than as a set of isolated exercises.

Learners need repeated practice in four stages: first, forming an accurate sentence; second, linking two clauses with the correct connector; third, building a short coherent paragraph; and fourth, expanding that paragraph into a complete composition with a beginning, development and ending. Composition writing remains central because it draws together all aspects of language production.

Written comprehension should also remain a focus. Candidates still perform more strongly on direct questions than on inferential ones, especially when the answer is not stated explicitly in the text and must be deduced from the situation.

For educators, the clearest message is that regular writing practice must now occupy an even more central place in classroom work. Short daily sentence tasks, sentence combining, guided paragraphing, explicit correction and redrafting are not optional extras. They are the foundation that will allow learners to move more confidently from basic literacy to the sustained written control expected at secondary level.

This is especially important in Kreol Morisien, which is the mother tongue of the large majority of candidates. Even though the subject continues to produce strong outcomes overall, the evidence from Questions 3A, 5, 8A, 8B and 9 shows clearly where the next gains in teaching and learning need to be made.